expanded war, he argued that China and the Soviet Union could be—indeed had to be—part of the solution. Indian officials suggested this could be facilitated if the People's Republic of China got the Chinese seat at the UN, where the issue could be resolved through diplomacy rather than force. American officials, however, thought Beijing was part of the problem and should not be rewarded with a UN seat for its part in the invasion. They resented Delhi's support for Moscow's efforts to get Beijing seated at the UN. Moreover, American officials saw this as distracting from the aggression in Korea,[132] and they criticized India for linking the latter and Chinese UN representation issues.[133]

India, in turn, disagreed with the Truman administration's linkage of Taiwan and Indochina-related issues with the Korean situation. Following the outbreak of the war, despite internal disagreements, the administration had announced an increase in aid to anticommunist forces in Indochina and its intention to defend Taiwan in the event of a communist attack. Indian policymakers thought the Korean War had already disturbed the stability in Asia; linking the additional issues would further destabilize the region. This mattered because they needed time for nation building and, as Nehru had asserted when he had been in Washington, "If there is war in any part of Asia it has some close effect on India."[134] Rudra Chaudhuri has suggested that this linkage, moreover, contributed to Indian hesitation about getting involved militarily in the US-led UN effort because it would "drag India into a US-led war against China."[135]

Indian officials believed that American actions such as the dispatch of the Seventh Fleet to the Taiwan Strait in June—even if intended as a defensive measure—would unnecessarily provoke China. Panikkar reported that the Chinese leadership differentiated between Korea, where Beijing did not want to get involved in the fighting, and Taiwan, where it would not back down. He suggested that the American approach would only push Beijing toward Moscow—a view shared by Kennan and others in the US.[136] Even China skeptics like Bajpai, who believed that Beijing saw India as a "potential rival,"[137] thought the American approach was counterproductive.[138] He also had a parochial concern about the escalating crisis: it might mean little potential economic or military assistance "left over in the USA for us."[139]